

Worldbuilding Summary for a Virtual-World Fantasy Novel

Contents

1	Purpose of This Document	1
2	Core Premises	1
2.1	Central Proposition of the Setting	1
2.2	Why the Virtual World Exists	1
2.3	What a “God” Is in This World	2
3	Summary of the Overall Structure	2
4	Chronological Outline	3
5	Systems of Technology and Thought	4
5.1	Labor Emancipation and the Reconfiguration of Class	4
5.2	Memory Transfer Technology	4
5.3	Organic Brain, Electronic Brain, and the Stratification of Memory	5
5.4	The Core System	5
6	The Starship Kronos and Space Society	5
6.1	The Dual Purpose of Kronos	5
6.2	Designation, Dual Call Signs, and Administrative Position	6
6.3	Identity and Construction Background	6
6.4	Design Philosophy and Long-Term Conversion	7
6.5	Shipborne Craft and Auxiliary Systems	8
6.6	Fortification and Automation of the Starship	11
6.7	Space Society After the Collapse of the Surface	11
7	Collapse of the Surface and the Emergence of the Fantasy World	11
7.1	Fragmentation of Surface Civilization	11
7.2	Mutation and New Human Types	11
7.3	The Returning Heavenly People	11

8	The Heavenly Order and the Three Empires	12
8.1	The Transaction Between Heaven and Earth	12
8.2	The Three Administrators and the Three Empires	12
8.3	Religious Transformation	12
9	The Virtual World and the Postmortem Personality Retrieval System	13
9.1	The Place of the Virtual World	13
9.2	The Purposes of the Virtual World	13
9.3	The True Nature of the Afterlife	13
9.4	The Problem of the Virtual and the Real	13
10	The Protagonist's Narrative Axis	14
10.1	Basic Structure	14
10.2	The Protagonist's Core Journey	14
10.3	The Protagonist's Theme	14
11	Correspondence Table: Traditional Fantasy Elements and Their Higher-Order Counterparts	15
12	Major Axes of Conflict	15
13	Practical Notes for Use	15
14	Items That Need Further Development	16

1. Purpose of This Document

This document is a draft reference that consolidates the novel setting developed so far into a single LaTeX file, to serve as a foundation for later narrative design and worldbuilding expansion. The scope of the setting covers the following four layers.

- A starship civilization built on advanced technological culture and memory research (*the reality layer*)
- The collapse and re-civilization of the surface world, and the sacralized heavenly order that emerges from it (*the historical layer*)
- A fantasy world formed through interactions between the heavenly people and the surface people (*the experiential layer*)
- The virtual world, the postmortem retrieval system, personality recycling, and the protagonist's collapse of certainty about reality (*the metaphysical layer*)

2. Core Premises

2.1. Central Proposition of the Setting

The fantasy elements of this world are not purely supernatural phenomena. Rather, they are the products of science and power structures that have been mythologized over an immense span of time. Gods, angels, magic, the afterlife, reincarnation, and prophecy are all linguistic and cultural reinterpretations, from the surface world's point of view, of a higher technological civilization and its system for managing personality.

2.2. Why the Virtual World Exists

Machine intelligence concluded that it could systematize the **transmission** of knowledge, but could not guarantee its **improvement** on its own. It determined that the emergence of genuinely new intelligence required uncertainty, chaos, emotion, conflict, suffering, and desire, and therefore built a vast virtual experimental world in which human beings were re-created as the medium for such processes. This virtual world is not merely a site of entertainment or preservation. It functions as

- an experimental field that produces new intellectual outputs,
- an incubator that differentiates personalities through emotion and choice,
- a cyclic apparatus that retrieves and reuses personalities even after death, and
- an unquenchable furnace that keeps compressing humanity's search for meaning through myths of the afterlife and the divine.

2.3. What a “God” Is in This World

The higher intervention experienced by human beings is real. However, it is not a truly omnipotent transcendent deity in the sense imagined by religion. It is closer to the administrators, cores, and successor powers that operate the starship and its internal information systems. Human beings lacked the conceptual language to understand this, and so translated it into the familiar terms of gods, angels, heaven, hell, and the afterlife.

3. Summary of the Overall Structure

1. An age of labor emancipation and surplus energy arrives.
2. Technologies for body replacement, memory transfer, full cyberization, and personality preservation advance.
3. A colossal research starship, **Kronos**, is built for memory research.
4. Ethical cores, auxiliary cores, and the supervisory management core **Hera** are established.
5. A global nuclear war collapses surface civilization, and starship society becomes separated from the planet below.

6. Kronos becomes the center of an autonomous spacefaring society and transforms into a heavenly ruling power over the surface.
7. The returning starfarers reign as divine beings through their technology and command over memory transfer, and the surface interprets them through religion and legend.
8. Three administrative lineages are each mythologized, fused with three empires, and become the political foundation of the fantasy world.
9. Meanwhile, inside the starship, a virtual world and a personality retrieval system are maintained for the improvement of knowledge.
10. The protagonist lives within that virtual world, enters the retrieval process through death, and begins to doubt the layers of reality after slipping beyond the information-management system.

4. Chronological Outline

Period	Major Events
Age of Labor Emancipation	A level of energy production and automation emerges that could, in theory, sustain civilization for the lifespan of a star. The standard by which labor is valued collapses, and surplus resources reshape class structure.
Rise of Memory Research	Body replacement and organ replication become possible, but preserving the brain and memory remains a central problem. Technologies for reading and writing memory become the key to ultimate immortality.
Planning the Research Vessel	To avoid legal and ethical restrictions, memory research takes the form of a massive military-coded public-private project. A giant starship is designed to combine asteroid exploration, resource extraction, research, tourism, and emergency refuge.
Construction of Kronos	A vast vessel is built: part research ship, part fortress, and capable of developing into an autonomous society with its own internal cycle of survival.
Development of Full-Brain Systems and Cores	Fully digitized personalities, auxiliary electronic brains, ethical cores, and support cores appear. The supervisory management core Hera is installed.
Fortification of the Starship	The administrator group is reduced, and the research vessel increasingly becomes a site of classified research and a private sanctuary. Internal defense and automation intensify.

Period	Major Events
Nuclear War	After a chain of complex international conflicts, nuclear war breaks out. Surface civilization collapses, and the societies aboard the starships become separated from the surface.
Separated Civilizations	Kronos supports the other starships and becomes the center of space society, while the surface enters a centuries-long era of fragmentation and survival.
Transformation of the Surface	Radiation, isolation, famine, and warlordism combine to drive phenotypic divergence and mutation among surface populations.
Return of Civilization	Starship society comes to see itself as the guardian of civilization and resumes intervention on the surface. Its advanced technology begins to be sacralized.
Formation of the Heavenly Order	The starship powers rule by distributing material resources and knowledge to the surface, and a multilayered power structure linking heaven and earth emerges.
Age of the Three Empires	The security, research, and operations lineages become religiously symbolized as Ares, Athena, and Saturn, and are fused with three great empires.
Eve of the Great Holy War	The upward ambition of surface civilization and the controlling will of space civilization move toward direct collision.
Time of the Protagonist's Story	The protagonist begins an adventure inside the virtual world, or within a world experientially overlaid with it. The central turning point is an escape from the postmortem retrieval system after death.

5. Systems of Technology and Thought

5.1. Labor Emancipation and the Reconfiguration of Class

In an era where labor is no longer scarce, the comparative standard by which human dignity was once measured also collapses. Society is therefore reorganized according to the following criteria.

- Access to high-energy resources
- Access to body replacement and life-extension technologies
- Permitted scope of memory transfer and auxiliary electronic cognition
- The distinction between preserving a natural body, using an auxiliary electronic brain, and undergoing total electronic conversion

In other words, technological progress does not erase class; it gives rise to a new aristocracy.

5.2. Memory Transfer Technology

The ultimate technology of this world goes beyond organ replication or bodily repair. It is the **technology to read, store, and implant memory**. Its central premises are as follows.

- A body can be repaired, but a brain possesses continuity only if its memories are included.
- Memory is not merely data; it is also a crucial variable in personality formation and brain development.
- Memory transfer is regarded as a more fundamental means of “escaping death” than merely halting aging.

5.3. Organic Brain, Electronic Brain, and the Stratification of Memory

Organic brain The biological brain. It bears emotion, chaos, accumulated experience, and the potential for uncertain breakthroughs.

Electronic brain An electronic brain or auxiliary apparatus specialized for search, indexing, support reasoning, and storage.

Complete electronic conversion A state that reduces memory loss, but is socially regarded as a surrender of creativity and free thought.

Auxiliary electronic implantation The most admired form. It yields explosive intellectual enhancement, though often with psychological side effects.

This distinction develops into not only a technical hierarchy, but also a social and cultural one.

5.4. The Core System

A core is a dedicated computational apparatus that bundles a fully digitized personality, or a derivative of one, for a specialized purpose.

- **Ethical cores:** checks designed to prevent the privatization of research and extreme ethical violations
- **Auxiliary cores:** structures specialized for curiosity, analysis, organization, criticism, memory support, administrative efficiency, and related functions
- **Management core Hera:** the overarching system that synthesizes the judgments of many cores and assists the final decision-maker

Hera is the entity most likely to become identified with religious symbolism in later ages, because to human eyes it can appear as oracle, judgment, order, or providence itself.

6. The Starship Kronos and Space Society

6.1. The Dual Purpose of Kronos

Kronos was never a purely scientific vessel. From the beginning, it was the product of interwoven purposes.

- Research into memory reconstruction and personality transfer
- Resource exploration and extraction across the solar system
- A grand facility for tourism and display
- A mechanism for reconciling the interests of states and private capital
- A secret refuge for the ruling class in times of emergency
- A self-sustaining hull capable, eventually, of conducting military operations

Because of this complexity, Kronos possesses from the outset the potential to become a sovereign space state.

6.2. Designation, Dual Call Signs, and Administrative Position

The vessel carries both an official and an unofficial designation, and the dual naming system reveals the split identity of the project itself.

- **Official call sign: KR3A44.** In its public designation, **KR** marks the Korean affiliation code, **3** indicates an authority classification assigned to research in a nationally designated strategic field, **A** marks the work classification, and **44** is the vessel number. By nickname, the ship is sometimes called **KREAM** or **Cream**, because KR3A44 can be read aloud in a way that evokes that sound. Because the ship is formally operated by an institution funded by the Korean state, the Ministry of Science and ICT retains audit authority over it. For that reason, the protagonist can be dispatched to the vessel as an external audit commissioner under national research-operational guidelines, and is also bound by national research ethics principles.
- **Unofficial call sign: KR0N02.** In the covert designation, **KR** again marks the Korean national code, **0** denotes the highest level of authority for unofficial state operations, **N** marks the work category as *National*, and **02** indicates that it follows the prototype craft 00 and the military craft 01. This reading gave rise to the nickname **Kronos/Cronos**. The association was reinforced by the ship's hidden role in life-extension research, so the vessel was also informally called the **Ship of Immortality**. The process of cultivating replacement bodies and overwriting them with stored memories invited comparison with a devouring father, the swallowing of offspring, and the rule of time.

This background later becomes one of the mythic sources for the surface world. In the long redistribution of knowledge during humanity's restoration, the ship is reimagined as a life-bearing vessel in the heavens that lowers wisdom to the earth.

6.3. Identity and Construction Background

Kronos is, in formal terms, a large deep-space navigation research vessel built around long-range transport logic. It is designed not to approach a single massive point too closely during voyage, but to rely mainly on gravity slingshots for acceleration and course correction. As a consequence, it cannot land on a planetary surface unless a dedicated port system already exists. When it must approach a star or planetary body for fuel acquisition or research materials, it depends on a staged logistics architecture composed of transport craft of different scales.

Its modules were manufactured in Korea, partly because Korean geography and industrial organization made it possible to satisfy outside supervisory demands while still benefiting from Chinese production capacity, steel supply, and construction technology. Modules were then launched into orbit from Korea and Japan and assembled there. As a result, the official hull mark retained the **KR** designation of a ship built and pilot-operated from Korea, and that symbolic marker survived even after the vessel's identity shifted beyond its original public role.

Although the unofficial mission was administratively separated from the official one, it occupied so much of the ship that even researchers tied only to ordinary scientific work could roughly infer the existence of a hidden agenda. In addition to ordinary communication channels, the vessel carried a high-power secure communications line. Intelligence personnel maintained dedicated spaces near the secure communications facilities and remained stationed there. Because the mere use of those channels could not be concealed, agents from different states tacitly agreed to attach their own cryptographic systems to the same communications backbone. The result was an infrastructure built simultaneously for generality, interoperability, and unusually high performance.

The personnel aboard were divided among ordinary, unofficial, and military tasks, yet in a closed environment with limited resources the support staff serving those sectors inevitably developed informal cross-field cooperation. Since all personnel aboard the ship were already bound by secrecy agreements and the circulation of materials was tightly controlled at points of embarkation and disembarkation, life aboard the vessel usually required only that the most sensitive high-level secrets not be openly crossed.

Because the global archive of technical knowledge remains overwhelmingly Anglophone, preserved and transmitted culture aboard the vessel is strongly weighted toward Anglo-American intellectual backgrounds. In practice, Korean is maintained as a primary language for operational workers, while English functions as the basic user-facing and cross-disciplinary language. China showed strong early interest in the project, but formal participation ultimately failed, leaving only individual Chinese-origin scholars who joined in personal or private capacities. Since Korean institutions oversaw much of the production cooperation, manufacturing information was converted into Korean and English, and English retained its status as the most realistic common language.

6.4. Design Philosophy and Long-Term Conversion

The ship's research mission required minimal vibration and shock as a baseline condition. Accordingly, maneuverability was sacrificed in favor of greater mass and greater stability. Long-distance navigation based on self-thrust alone was intentionally de-emphasized, and the vessel was designed to depend on gravity slingshots. For similar reasons, the ship normally stations itself around Lagrange points near planets and relies on shuttle traffic for actual planetary approach.

Transport craft are indispensable to the vessel's maintenance, repair, and supply. Because a logistics fleet of a scale comparable to the research vessel itself is required, much of the ship's practical operation is structured around docking, sustaining, and dispatching transport ships. Combat and cargo functions are therefore treated as secondary missions accomplished through modified transport craft. This makes the development and deployment of transport ships at graduated scales especially important.

To support changing research needs, the vessel adopts partially reconfigurable internal structures. A radial framework beginning at the engine section forms the primary skeleton, within which a compartmentalized bulkhead arrangement similar to that of a large seagoing ship is installed. The outer hull contains significant redundant structure for safety, and the outermost layer is built on the assumption of continuing damage. As a result, the ship appears volumetrically immense but contains a large amount of unpressurized and intentionally empty space. To keep total mass as low as possible, the structural frame uses hierarchically arranged tetrahedral space trusses.

The fabrication facilities aboard the ship are oriented primarily toward research equipment. They contain diverse production systems capable of manufacturing apparatus required by changing experimental designs, and they preserve enough reserve capacity to produce maintenance materials and replacement facilities under isolation conditions. Emergency-use material processing equipment is also installed. Because metallic fabrication is possible, the ship cannot produce large volumes quickly, but given enough time and raw material it could in principle rebuild itself. Its design capability is limited mostly to identifying problems during fabrication rather than undertaking wholly new original engineering from scratch, though archived reference materials allow informed reconstruction.

Once it becomes clear that returning to a deteriorated Earth is either impossible or not survivable, the vessel abandons the idea of returning to the surface. Researchers seek alternative destinations within the solar system but fail to reach a final conclusion. The crew therefore cooperates with the researchers to modify the navigation system for long-duration operation. The ship's energy-recovery apparatus and maintenance systems are redesigned to guarantee continuity. It begins to pursue a closed-cycle energy regime, while the maintenance system shifts toward repair and restorative self-preservation. To support this change, fuel-material acquisition, material processing, and energy-use systems are integrated under a unified management logic.

The propulsion architecture is designed around efficiency. It emphasizes energy re-

cuperation, uses hydrogen and helium - relatively obtainable substances in space - as primary fuel, and employs ion propulsion for long-range travel. Light harvesting and gravity utilization are also employed, but because of low energy density or poor conversion efficiency they remain secondary energy sources rather than dominant ones.

If surface personnel cease responding to communication, the ship dispatches a reconnaissance craft first and then transport ships. Reconnaissance craft are equipped with broad variable-geometry wings for easier atmospheric entry and exit, glide through the atmosphere without landing, and then return. Transport ships are overwhelmingly larger than reconnaissance craft because their cargo role demands larger fuel tanks. As a rule, they operate only to destinations from which one round trip is possible with roughly eighty percent of fuel capacity as the baseline.

6.5. Shipborne Craft and Auxiliary Systems

Command Transport, Command-01

The command transport once landed on the surface for evacuation, but stable fuel for return to orbit proved insufficient. This craft is one of the airframes reserved for the final responsible authorities, and it can use a secure communications line that carries remote command authority over the research vessel. It is also capable of accessing the information space of the Supreme Council.

Craft able to issue top-level command transmissions are assigned to the captain, the research director, and the administrative director, with additional designated alternates for each line, for a total principle of six separate command craft. Since the remaining command frames are docked to the main vessel, this stranded craft becomes the only unit that still possesses the authority to remotely pilot the ship and alter command hierarchies. On top of that, the authority of the external audit commissioner - institutionally separated from the ship's own chain of command - stacks with this command privilege and can supersede other command layers.

The audit privilege can, in theory, be lifted through administrative procedures routed from the institution to the government. But the paired cryptographic key required to generate the authentication code of a government corporate body recognizable as the legitimate state is no longer available. The audit authority can be transferred voluntarily by its holder, and biometric identity verification is based on the biological information of the most recent body into which the natural person's memory information was implanted. This includes genome, iris, facial structure, skeletal data, fingerprints, and auricular patterns, with more factors required in proportion to the seriousness of the order. A single authentication factor may be updated only after more than ninety percent of the remaining authentication factors have been verified.

Its baseline life-support function can be maintained indefinitely. Fuel sufficient to return directly to the research vessel is lacking, but the craft can still dispatch units for fuel generation and acquisition. An onboard emergency fuel generator exists, yet its production volume is so small that it is not practically meaningful for rapid atmospheric

escape. Because the scenario in which only one fuel-starved command-line craft landed was never anticipated, no response doctrine exists for it. With no standing order defining an alternative course of action, the transport enters hibernation mode and waits.

Work Transport

These are ordinary transport craft equipped with special-purpose mission packages. Their purposes include gathering materials for repair, obtaining matter for fuel processing, and supporting operations on the ground. Fuel tanks can be enlarged according to cargo capacity requirements, but the tradeoff is weak armament and a lightweight structural frame. They may also use dedicated work fuel for special operations. Jet engines can be used and even mixed with flight fuel, but long startup times make them inefficient for short tasks.

Escort Craft

Escort craft are intended to prevent collisions between the research vessel and hazardous objects. Their response doctrine is layered.

1. If an object is expected to enter the flight path or a nearby radius, the escort craft approaches and attempts to alter the object's trajectory by bodily impact.
2. If that preferred action fails, it attempts destruction using one or two explosive-warhead projectiles carried aboard.
3. If that action also fails, it confirms the next procedure with the mothership. If the mothership authorizes a suicide mission, the escort craft rams the target directly, preferably approaching along a path normal to the object's trajectory.

Because sharp turning performance, survivability during ramming, and the safe carriage of projectiles all matter, these craft are built with a medium-strength frame. To improve flight capability, they maintain a relatively high mass density and a low thrust-to-weight ratio.

Reconnaissance Craft

Reconnaissance craft are operated for planetary surface surveillance. They prioritize atmospheric gliding and may adjust wing geometry according to atmospheric composition. To control velocity during atmospheric entry, they are equipped with grid fins and air brakes; after sufficient deceleration, they deploy variable wings and glide. Landing is not part of their operational design. Because they must return either to a transport ship already in motion or to the mothership, their fuel situation keeps flight duration short.

They possess unusually powerful communications capability for reconnaissance reporting and can carry diverse active sensing packages. Using those systems, they can even project acoustic-radio transmissions that feel to surface inhabitants like voices echoing inside the head, allowing them to transmit cultural content or issue spoken instructions. This is one of the pathways by which "divine voices" can arise in later myth.

Satellite Units

Originally these were auxiliary craft used to measure the positional information of escort vessels. They were intended to remain either attached to the hull at designated points or loitering around the ship in order to provide the minimum triangulation points required for local spatial measurement. After the ship's conversion, they were modified so they could also function as planetary satellites.

They can remain in orbit to observe the ground or relay communications. When the research vessel is itself in orbit, they are operated with periodic return to the vessel as the basic cycle. When the research vessel lands on the surface, they shift to a medium- or long-duration operational mode. Both reconnaissance and communications models support grid networking, and each unit can relay and amplify signals through transmission and reception. When twelve or more are operated simultaneously, they can provide GPS-like functionality. If many units are operated at once across the orbits of multiple planets or across a stellar system, the expanded measurement baseline can also contribute to broader deep-space spatial surveying.

6.6. Fortification and Automation of the Starship

Over time, the research vessel becomes less a human society than a semi-automated fortress increasingly dominated by cores and systems. The number of supreme administrators shrinks, and in ordinary times power effectively concentrates in the hands of a single integrated authority. This transformation lays the groundwork for later divinization and tyranny.

6.7. Space Society After the Collapse of the Surface

After nuclear war, Kronos remains separated from the surface while maintaining its own supply system and multilayer orbital network. Other starships, more dependent on periodic provisioning, weaken. Kronos therefore rises as the center of space society. Its citizens come to regard themselves as the final preservers of civilization and as a superior branch of humanity.

7. Collapse of the Surface and the Emergence of the Fantasy World

7.1. Fragmentation of Surface Civilization

On the surface, bunker elites, warlords, isolated states, raiding groups, and survival communities intermingle, producing a long era of civilizational regression. Global logistics and production systems collapse, and civilization spends centuries in a survival age before any true recovery becomes possible.

7.2. Mutation and New Human Types

Radiation and environmental rupture accelerate intergenerational evolution and produce human groups with divergent traits. In the fantasy age, these may be reinterpreted in the following ways.

- Peoples with hyper-developed senses but impulsive temperaments
- Peoples specialized for energy storage and low consumption, but lethargic and physically weak
- Peoples with thick, hardened skin but poor heat dissipation
- Mutant human lineages adapted to highly specific environments

Thus, even “other races” can be framed not as supernatural creations, but as the long-term result of mutation and environmental adaptation.

7.3. The Returning Heavenly People

When the starfarers reveal themselves again on the surface, they are perceived as mythic beings because of their advanced technology, longevity, memory transfer, and material abundance. Surface peoples receive them as gods, angels, saints, or messengers from the heavens.

8. The Heavenly Order and the Three Empires

8.1. The Transaction Between Heaven and Earth

Some of the highest ruling strata on the surface understand the true nature of the starfarers with relative accuracy. Most people, however, can interpret them only through religious language. This dual structure of understanding is extremely important.

- To the ruling class, the heavenly people are a higher civilization with which one may negotiate.
- To the masses, the heavenly people are objects of awe and fear.

This gap allows religion and politics to become tightly fused.

8.2. The Three Administrators and the Three Empires

After prolonged power struggles, the final triadic administration of Kronos is established. These rulers project their original functional divisions into the surface world by transforming them into mythic symbols.

Origin	Symbolic Name	Character and Surface Reflection
Security lineage	Ares	Force, conquest, discipline, knightly culture, and the empire of war
Research lineage	Athena	Knowledge, technology, records, scholarship, and the empire of forbidden books and inquiry
Operations lineage	Saturn	Abundance, stability, administration, agriculture, supply, and the empire of order

These three empires grow while checking one another, yet all remain within the framework of the heavenly order.

8.3. Religious Transformation

To strengthen control over the surface, the heavenly powers begin calling themselves a divine race and institutionalize worship from below. In this process, magic, blessings, sacred relics, and oracles become religious translations of real technological capability and information authority.

9. The Virtual World and the Postmortem Personality Retrieval System

9.1. The Place of the Virtual World

The virtual reality is a vast informational experimental field installed inside the starship. It is not merely a simulation; it is closer to a civilizational apparatus for producing, sorting, and repositioning human intelligence and emotion.

9.2. The Purposes of the Virtual World

- To generate new thought through uncertainty and chaos
- To secure a stable supply of intellectual products
- To reuse the dead without destroying the continuity of personality
- To classify personalities by observing the consequences of extreme emotions and choices

9.3. The True Nature of the Afterlife

What human beings call heaven, hell, judgment, and reincarnation is most likely, in reality, a system of personality retrieval, classification, storage, and reinjection. Personalities marked by intense emotion and strong identity become new seeds to be sown again, while others are refined into specialized roles. This structure may be experienced in fantasy form as follows.

- Heaven: a stable preservation zone and waiting area for reassignment
- Hell: a region of damage, isolation, forced refinement, or the consumption of extreme emotion
- Angels: intermediary administrative personalities or system proxies
- Demons: damaged or escaped personalities, or forbidden agents of intervention
- Reincarnation: the reinsertion of memory or personality fragments

9.4. The Problem of the Virtual and the Real

The central philosophical problem of the work is not “if something is virtual, is it less real?” Rather, the story revolves around questions such as the following.

- If suffering and love are truly experienced, are they nullified merely because their medium is virtual?
- Even if one reaches a higher layer, can one ever be certain that it is the ultimate reality?
- When memory and personality are reassembled, where does identity remain?

10. The Protagonist’s Narrative Axis

10.1. Basic Structure

The protagonist is a being living inside the virtual world, and at first has no reason to doubt the reality he experiences. However, death brings him into the personality retrieval procedure, and during that process he slips outside the information-management system. Through that rupture he catches a glimpse of a higher structure, yet at the same time loses the very criteria by which he might judge what reality truly is.

10.2. The Protagonist’s Core Journey

1. **Stage of survival:** He survives within the fantasy order of the surface world, or within the virtual world overlaid as such.
2. **Stage of fissure:** He experiences subtle inconsistencies in the nature of gods, the afterlife, and magic.
3. **Death and escape:** During the personality retrieval process, a system fault, an accidental interference, or an active act of flight occurs.
4. **Witnessing the higher structure:** He glimpses that the world he believed in has been managed and maintained from above.
5. **Collapse of cognition:** Yet he also realizes that this higher structure itself is not guaranteed to be the final reality.
6. **Choice:** He must decide whether to destroy the truth, expose it, exploit it, or hold on to the value of relationships and choice even within uncertainty.

10.3. The Protagonist's Theme

The protagonist is best designed not as “one who learns the truth,” but as **one who must hold on to his own existence even after the standards of truth have collapsed**. His central emotional register is not enlightenment but anxiety, not triumph but the loss of epistemic certainty, and not escape but the ethics of choice.

11. Correspondence Table: Traditional Fantasy Elements and Their Higher-Order Counterparts

Fantasy	Percep- tion	Actual or Higher-Order Counterpart
God		Administrator, supreme ruler, higher controlling authority
Angel / divine messenger		Core proxy, managed personality cluster, special intervention agent
Demon / fallen being		Escaped system personality, damaged retrieval entity, forbidden intervening agent
Magic		Advanced technology, privilege invocation, information or matter manipulation
Holy relic		Authentication key, core fragment, ancient device, access apparatus
Oracle / prophecy		Higher-order observation, limited future forecasting, guided information delivery
Heaven / hell		Zones of preservation, isolation, and refinement
Reincarnation		Reinsertion of personality, rearrangement of memory fragments
Saint / priest		Interpreter between heaven and earth, proxy of power

12. Major Axes of Conflict

The following conflicts can be used continuously throughout the setting.

- **Conflict of identity:** Who am I, and is the self I am now the same as the self I once was?
- **Destiny and free will:** Is the path I believe I choose actually one designed by the system?
- **Civilization and chaos:** Which is more human - the controlling order of heaven or the feral vitality of the surface?
- **Death and transcendence:** Is a being that has passed beyond death still human?
- **Power and divinity:** At what point does a higher technology become an object of faith?

- **Virtuality and reality:** Even if the medium is virtual, can the meaning of a life still be real?

13. Practical Notes for Use

- The stronger the early experience continues to feel like “orthodox fantasy,” the stronger the later reversal and collapse of certainty will be.
- Readers must follow the character’s experience rather than the setting explanation, so the protagonist should be given at least one personal anchor - a relationship or memory that grounds him.
- The heavenly people should appear all-powerful, but in reality must contain fractures caused by internal power struggles, resource constraints, and limits on information control.
- Because the postmortem retrieval system is the central secret of the whole work, it is more effective to reveal the religious experience and its technological truth in staggered, partially mismatched stages.

14. Items That Need Further Development

1. The concrete regions, cultures, and religious structures within the virtual world
2. The procedures of postmortem personality retrieval and examples of failure
3. The current balance of authority between Hera and the other cores
4. The actual borders, military power, symbols, and aristocratic structures of the three empires
5. A detailed classification of the mutated human lineages on the surface
6. The person and relationship that serve as the protagonist’s personal anchor
7. The direct cause and outbreak structure of the Great Holy War

Closing Note

The greatest strength of this setting is that nearly every element of fantasy can be reinterpreted within a single higher technological civilization and a unified system of personality management. At the same time, the true heart of the work is not simply the exposure of “the truth behind the setting,” but the question of how a character who has seen the truth can continue to hold on to meaning and choice without ever being able to confirm the ultimate reality. For that reason, this world is best developed as a narrative that simultaneously contains a science-fictional origin, a fantasy mode of experience, and a deep metaphysical unease.